

ARTICLES

A, AN, THE

Articles are small words used before a noun.
They help us know whether the noun is general or specific.

A

We use **A** before a **consonant** sound (a general one).



a book
(any book)



a cat
(any cat)



a boy
(any boy)



a car
(any car)



Remember:

A → consonant sound
(a book, a cat, a boy, a car)

AN

We use **AN** before a **vowel** sound (a general one).



an apple
(any apple)



an elephant
(any elephant)



an umbrella
(any umbrella)



an hour
(any hour)



Remember:

AN → vowel sound
(an apple, an elephant,
an umbrella, an hour)

THE

We use **THE** for a **specific** person, place or thing.



the boy
(a particular boy)



the school
(this school)



the sun
(the sun we know)



the book
(this book)



Remember:

THE → specific
(the boy, the school, the sun, the book)

Quick Examples



I have **an** orange.
(vowel sound)



This is **a** dog.
(consonant sound)



The tree is tall.
(specific)



I read **a** book.
(general)



It is **an** umbrella.
(vowel sound)



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Rules to be Followed to Use

Articles

(a, an, the)

Small words...
Big meaning!



1 Use **a** before a consonant sound.

We use **a** before words that begin with a consonant sound (b, c, d, f, g, h, j, k, ...).

Examples:

- **a** boy
- **a** cat
- **a** book
- **a** tree



2 Use **an** before a vowel sound.

We use **an** before words that begin with a vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u).

Examples:

- **an** apple
- **an** egg
- **an** orange
- **an** umbrella



3 Use **the** before a specific person, place or thing.

We use **the** when we are talking about something specific or already known.

Examples:

- **the** book on **the** table
- **the** girl in **the** picture
- **the** sun in **the** sky
- **the** school near my house



4 Do not use **an** article with plural nouns or uncountable nouns (general sense).

We don't use **a**, **an** or **the** with plural nouns or uncountable nouns when we are talking in general.

Examples:

- ✗ I like apples. (plural)
- ✗ I need water. (uncountable)
- ✗ We play football. (general)
- ✗ She reads books. (general)



5 Remember!

- ✓ **a** – before a consonant sound
- ✓ **an** – before a vowel sound
- ✓ **the** – for something specific
- ✓ **No article** – for plural or uncountable nouns (in general sense)

Practice
and
be a
Grammar
Star!



It's about
the sound!

Use **a** or **an**

based on the sound of the
first letter of the word,
not the spelling.

Listen
Say
Choose!



The Rule for "A" and "An"

A

- Use **a** before a **consonant sound** (even if the word starts with a vowel letter like u or e).

An

- Use **an** before a **vowel sound** or a **silent h** (even if the word starts with a consonant letter like h or m).

A

Special Examples with **A** (Consonant Sound)



Even though these words start with the vowel u or e, they are pronounced with a "y" sound (yu), which is a consonant sound.



- **A university**
(sounds like yu-niversity)



- **A unique opportunity**
(sounds like yu-nique)



- **A uniform**
(sounds like yu-niform)



- **A European**
(sounds like yu-ropean)



- **A one-way street**
(starts with a "w" sound: wun)

An

Special Examples with **An** (Vowel / Silent Sound)



Even though these words start with a consonant letter like h, the letter is silent, or the word starts with a consonant that makes a vowel sound.



- **An honest person**
(the h is silent, sounds like onest)



- **An hour**
(the h is silent, sounds like our)



- **An honor**
(the h is silent, sounds like onor)



- **An MBA**
(starts with m, but pronounced with an "eh" sound: em-bee-ay)



- **An FBI agent**
(starts with f, pronounced with an "eh" sound: ef-bi)



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A

Use **a** before a **consonant** sound.

- Examples: a boy, a cat, a book



An

Use **an** before a **vowel** sound or a **silent h**.

- Examples: an apple, an hour, an honest person



The

Use **the** for a **specific** person, place or thing.

- Examples: the book, the school, the sun



Fill in the blanks

-  _____ apple is red.
-  _____ cat is sleeping.
-  _____ elephant is big.
-  I have _____ umbrella.
-  This is _____ book.
-  6. _____ sun is shining.
-  . She has _____ ball.
-  8. _____ boy is my friend.
-  9. We live in _____ house.
-  10. _____ hour is 60 minutes.

-  He goes to _____ university.
-  12. _____ honest man is kind.
-  13. I saw _____ hen in the yard.
-  14. _____ orange is juicy.
-  15. It is _____ rainy day.
-  16. _____ FBI agent is brave.
-  17. _____ one-way street is busy.
-  18. She is _____ European.
-  19. He has _____ MBA degree.
-  20. The tree is tall. _____ tree is old.



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